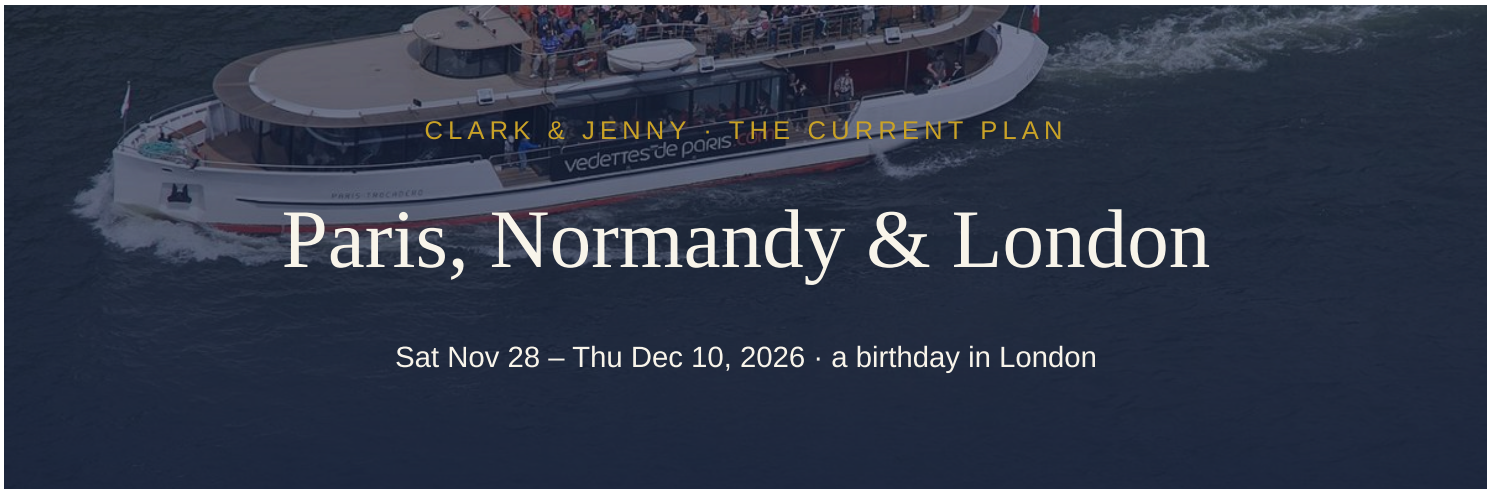


CLARK & JENNY · THE CURRENT PLAN

Paris, Normandy & London

Sat Nov 28 – Thu Dec 10, 2026 · a birthday in London

FLIGHTS BOOKED. HOTELS, TRAINS AND DINNERS FROM SAT DEC 5 ON ARE READY TO BOOK SOON, NOT BOOKED YET.

The Paris week is unchanged. Then five extra days: a night facing Mont-Saint-Michel, a night in Bayeux by the D-Day coast, and three nights in London with the birthday dinner on Mon Dec 7. Same rhythm: slow mornings, one light anchor a day, one proper dinner.

Weather: Normandy and London in December are cool, grey and damp, highs around 45–48 °F, windy on the coast; sunset ~4:55 PM in Normandy and ~3:50 PM in London. Pack layers, a waterproof jacket and good shoes.

Flights (booked, United Polaris via Chicago): Out Sat Nov 28: UA5867 Traverse City 2:18 PM → O'Hare 2:55 PM, then UA987 O'Hare 6:45 PM → Paris CDG 9:55 AM Nov 29. Home Thu Dec 10 (open-jaw from London Heathrow T2): UA928 1:35 PM → O'Hare 4:55 PM (seats 4D/5F), then UA2304 O'Hare 7:45 PM → Traverse City 9:59 PM (First, 2E/2F).

DAY 0

Sat Nov 28 · Travel day

Anchor: Get to Paris rested.



Morning	Pack, and a relaxed early afternoon departure from home.
Afternoon	**UA5867** 2:18 PM → O'Hare 2:55 PM (seats 2C/2D), short hop from Traverse City (TVC) to Chicago O'Hare on United. Time in the United Polaris lounge: sit-down dinner, shower suite, quiet room.
Evening	Overnight United Polaris flight Chicago → Paris CDG. Dinner was in the lounge, so sleep early. **UA987** O'Hare 6:45 PM → Paris CDG 9:55 AM Sun Nov 29 (seats 3D/3F).

DAY 1

Sun Nov 29 · Arrive and settle

Anchor: None. Land, rest, tub.



Morning	Land at CDG Terminal 1 mid-morning. Pre-booked car to the hotel (hotel car or Welcome Pickups). Drop bags at Hôtel Le Cinq Codet around noon.
Afternoon	Latte at Noir – Rue de Grenelle, pastry from La Parisienne. Check in at 3 PM, nap and the tub. Optional wander down Rue Cler.
Evening	Dusk walk to the Champ de Mars (sunset ~4:57 PM; the Tower sparkles on the hour). 7:30 PM dinner at Bistrot des Fables. Jenny: salmon with sorrel or sea bream. Dessert: bourbon-vanilla crème brûlée.

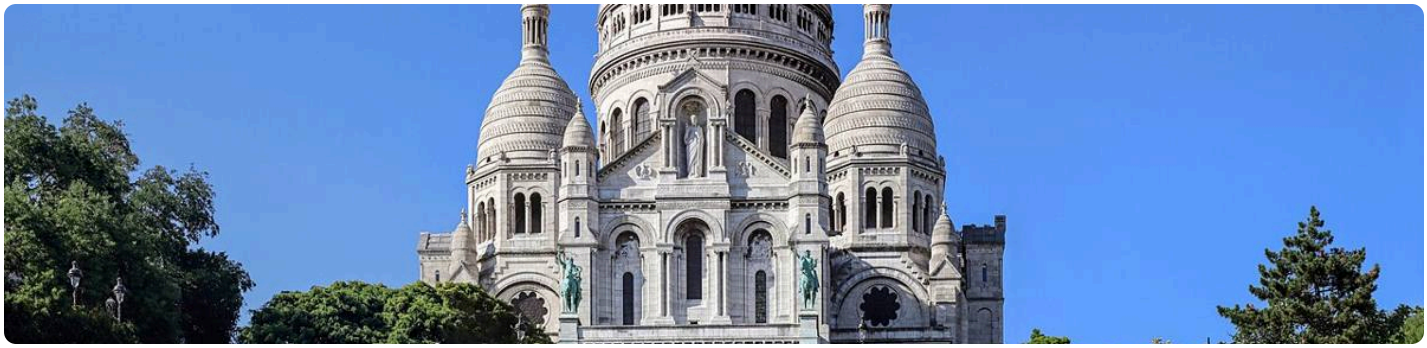
DAY 2

Mon Nov 30 · Montmartre at sunset + Moulin Rouge

Anchor: One evening outing.



Morning	Late start. Latte at Dialogues Coffee, then tub and rest.
Afternoon	1 PM lunch at Les Cocottes (Jenny: roast cod). ~3:15 taxi to Montmartre; dress smart for tonight. Ride the funicular up to Sacré-Cœur.
Evening	Sunset from the basilica steps (~4:56 PM), stroll Place du Tertre. **Moulin Rouge Dinner & Show**: doors 6:45, dinner with the orchestra at 7 PM, Féerie show at 9 PM. Jenny: the **Belle Époque menu** (smoked salmon, then pike-perch) — flag the shellfish allergy when booking. Smart dress, no trainers. Taxi home ~11 PM. Book only via reservations.moulinrouge.fr.



Sacré-Cœur, Montmartre

DAY 3

Tue Dec 1 · Catacombs + lunch at Baguette

Anchor: The Catacombs, then a long lunch.



Morning	~9:15 filter coffee at Coutume. Metro line 6 to Denfert-Rochereau. 10:30 timed entry at the Catacombes de Paris (~1 hr, 131 steps down / 112 up, ~14 °C inside — bring a layer, no big bags).
Afternoon	Taxi to Montorgueil. 12:15 lunch at Baguette, French-Asian small plates. Jenny: salmon tartare with ginger, truffle risotto, smoked aubergine — skip the shrimp spring roll. Dessert: black-sesame crème brûlée. Keep it light. Taxi back, rest and tub.
Evening	7:30 PM dinner at Café Caillou. Jenny: fresh salmon, mushroom risotto or aubergine gratin. Clark: a Chinon by the bottle.



The Montorgueil quarter, home of Baguette

DAY 4

Wed Dec 2 · Versailles + Gordon Ramsay au Trianon

Anchor: The palace, then the starred dinner. Long day; taxi home.



Morning	~9:15 pastry; dress smart casual for dinner. ~9:45 RER C from Champ de Mars–Tour Eiffel to Versailles Château Rive Gauche (~35–40 min). 11:00 timed entry, Palace of Versailles (Passport ticket).
Afternoon	~1 PM lunch at Ore – Ducasse in the palace grounds. Jenny: truite aux amandes; skip the raw scallops. ~2:30 gardens, then the Trianons and Marie-Antoinette's Hamlet (last entry 4:45).
Evening	~5 PM drinks at the Waldorf Astoria Trianon Palace bar: an Old Fashioned for Clark, Crémant for Jenny. 7:30 PM Gordon Ramsay au Trianon ★ — request a pescatarian, shellfish-free menu at booking (signatures use lobster and cockles). ~10:15 pre-booked taxi back to the hotel: **the RER C closes evenings from 11 PM for works**.



Trianon Palace, home of Gordon Ramsay au Trianon

DAY 5

Thu Dec 3 · The big-view day

Anchor: The 5 PM Seine cruise.



Morning	~10:00 slow coffee at Dialogues. Optional walk over Pont d'Iéna to the Trocadéro esplanade for the classic Tower view.
Afternoon	1 PM light lunch at Les Cocottes. Tub and rest. Leave 4:35, dressed warm.
Evening	5 PM cruise with Bateaux Parisiens (Port de la Bourdonnais), back ~6 PM as the Tower sparkles. Old Fashioned at Minuit Express. ~7:45 dinner at Le Bosquet (Jenny: grilled cod, sauce vierge — oysters on the menu, flag the allergy).

DAY 6

Fri Dec 4 · Super-relaxed last day

Anchor: None. Early night.



Morning	Late breakfast from La Parisienne, latte at Noir, last stroll down Rue Cler.
Afternoon	Light lunch at Les Cocottes. Hotel spa and a long soak. Pack; confirm the morning car.
Evening	7 PM farewell dinner at La Fontaine de Mars. Jenny: salmon in salt crust or roasted sea bass. Dessert: crème brûlée à la vanille. Lights out ~10.

DAY 7 **READY TO BOOK**

Sat Dec 5 · Paris → Mont-Saint-Michel

Anchor: Arrive at the Mont by sunset.



Morning	Slow breakfast and check out of Le Cinq Codet (~10:30). Taxi to Paris-Montparnasse for a late-morning TGV to Rennes (~1 hr 30, book on SNCF Connect). Ready to book: trains open well ahead.
Afternoon	Pick up a premium sedan (the car makes Sunday's D-Day coast easy; the no-car fallback is the Keolis Rennes → Mont-Saint-Michel bus, daily and timed to the Paris TGVs) or SUV at SIXT Rennes station (one-way, returned in Caen on Monday). Easy, toll-free drive to the Mont (~1 hr 15). Check in at Le Relais Saint-Michel — ask for a room facing the Mont.
Evening	Sunset (~4:55 PM) from the hotel terrace, then the free shuttle across and a quiet walk up the lit, empty village. Dinner at the Relais Saint-Michel restaurant facing the lit Mont (open nightly 7–9:30 PM). Jenny: local fish of the day; Normandy is shellfish country, so flag the allergy every time.

DAY 8 **READY TO BOOK**

Sun Dec 6 · The abbey + the D-Day coast

Anchor: Late-morning abbey, afternoon at the American Cemetery.



Morning	Breakfast with the view. ~10:30 Mont-Saint-Michel Abbey (~1 hr 30, many steps; dress warm, the wind is sharp).
Afternoon	Light lunch, then drive to the D-Day coast (~1 hr 45 on the A84). Normandy American Cemetery above Omaha Beach; arrive by ~2:30 to have daylight, the site closes at 5 PM.
Evening	~20 min to Bayeux. Check in at Château de Bellefontaine. Walk to the lit cathedral. Dinner at Le Pommier (open Sunday evenings in winter, 6:30–8:30 PM; Normandy produce with real vegetarian and fish choices). La Rapière is closed on Sundays. Early-ish night.



Old Bayeux

DAY 9 **READY TO BOOK**

Mon Dec 7 · Birthday · Normandy → London

Anchor: A gentle travel day, then the birthday dinner.



Morning	Sleep in. Late breakfast and a stroll through old Bayeux (the Tapestry itself is in London this year — see Tuesday). ~11:00 drive 30 min to Caen and return the car at the station.
Afternoon	Midday Nomad train Caen → Paris-Saint-Lazare (~2 hrs), 15-min taxi to Gare du Nord, then the 4:12 PM Eurostar (Business Premier for lounge and a meal) arriving St Pancras ~5:35 PM London time. Car to Mayfair, time to dress for dinner. The ferry is not a good fit: the afternoon Ouistreham sailing lands in Portsmouth ~9:30 PM, still two hours from London. Check in at Claridge's, Mayfair.
Evening	Birthday dinner, ~8 PM. Top pick: Core by Clare Smyth (request a pescatarian, shellfish-free menu at booking). Alternatives: Hélène Darroze at The Connaught (3 stars, a short walk from Claridge's) or Claridge's Restaurant (no taxi at all). Old Fashioned first in the hotel bar; Champagne or English sparkling for Jenny; crème brûlée if it is on.

DAY 10 **READY TO BOOK**

Tue Dec 8 · The Bayeux Tapestry in London

Anchor: One timed museum visit.



Morning	Slow morning. 11 AM timed entry to The Bayeux Tapestry at the British Museum — on loan from Normandy for the first time in nearly 1,000 years, a perfect bookend to the trip. **Tickets through March 2027 are sold out**: watch for returns, or join as a Member for access.
Afternoon	Lunch nearby, then rest at the hotel.
Evening	Christmas lights on Regent Street and Bond Street on foot from Mayfair. Relaxed dinner.

DAY 11 **READY TO BOOK**

Wed Dec 9 · London at Christmas

Anchor: Winter Wonderland at dusk.



Morning	Late breakfast. Wander Mayfair and Burlington Arcade.
Afternoon	Afternoon tea or a long lunch. Rest and pack.
Evening	Stroll into Hyde Park Winter Wonderland after dark (open Nov 19 – Jan 3). Farewell dinner; early night.

DAY 12 **FLIGHTS BOOKED**

Thu Dec 10 · Fly home from Heathrow

Anchor: A relaxed last morning, then Polaris home.



Morning	Late breakfast at Claridge's and a slow pack. Leave around 10:30 AM by car (about an hour), or take a taxi to Paddington and the Heathrow Express (15 min). Reach Heathrow Terminal 2 about 11:30.
Afternoon	**UA928** Heathrow T2 1:35 PM → Chicago O'Hare 4:55 PM, United Polaris (Boeing 767-300). Seats: Clark 4D, Jenny 5F (center seats, one diagonally behind the other).
Evening	2h50 connection at O'Hare: clear passport control and customs, re-check bags and re-screen, then a sit-down dinner in the United Polaris lounge (Terminal 1, near gate C18). **UA2304** O'Hare 7:45 PM → Traverse City 9:59 PM, First, seats 2E/2F.

READY TO BOOK

Open items

Item	What
Hotels to book (top pick, then alternatives)	Mont-Saint-Michel Dec 5: Le Relais Saint-Michel (open all year, rooms and restaurant facing the Mont; ask for a Mont-view room). Alternatives: La Mère Poulard (historic inn inside the walls, open all year) or Les Terrasses Poulard / La Confiance (in the village; many steps with bags). Avoid Hôtel Gabriel and Relais du Roy: closed in winter. Bayeux Dec 6: Château de Bellefontaine (18th-century château in a park, a walk from the cathedral). Alternative: Hôtel d'Argouges (18th-century mansion in town). Villa Lara is closed from Nov 30 to Dec 31. London Dec 7–10: Claridge's (Art Deco Mayfair, famous Christmas tree). Alternatives: The Connaught (quiet Mayfair, Hélène Darroze downstairs) or Rosewood London (Holborn, a walk to the British Museum).
Rental car	Premium sedan or SUV, Rennes station Sat Dec 5

	→ Caen station Mon Dec 7 (one-way, same country).
Trains	Paris → Rennes TGV (Dec 5); Caen → Paris and Eurostar Paris → London (Dec 7). Ferry from Caen to Portsmouth is the alternative.
Birthday dinner	Core by Clare Smyth (top pick), Hélène Darroze at The Connaught, or Claridge's Restaurant, Mon Dec 7 ~8 PM — pescatarian, no shellfish.
British Museum	Bayeux Tapestry timed entry, Tue Dec 8 (autumn tickets are listed as sold out — check for returns or member slots).

Dining notes

Jenny: pescatarian, shellfish allergy

> **Je suis allergique aux fruits de mer et crustacés. Je mange du poisson mais pas de fruits de mer.**
> *In London: "Pescatarian, with a shellfish allergy — no prawns, crab, lobster, scallops, mussels or oysters, and no shellfish stock."*

Normandy menus lean on oysters, mussels and scallops; ask for the fish of the day (sole, bar, cabillaud, saumon). Jenny: Crémant or Champagne in France, English sparkling in London. Clark: bold reds, an Old Fashioned in the hotel bar, crème brûlée when it appears.

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